

# Asynchronous Module: The Human Person Facing Death (Grade 12)

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## Day 1: The Personal Encounter with Mortality and Fear

**Focus:** Mortality and the Fear of Death (Thanatophobia)

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### I. Introduction & Activation

#### 1. Pre-Assessment

##### 5-Question Multiple-Choice Quiz: Initial Associations

1. c) The inevitability of death
2. b) Living forever
3. c) What one leaves behind after death
4. a) Anxiety
5. a) Death

### 2. Philosophical Context

After exploring the concept of existentialism, I realized that understanding life's limits gives us a deeper sense of responsibility. Knowing that our time is temporary motivates us to value our relationships, appreciate the present, and pursue meaningful goals. Death awareness does not have to bring fear; it can awaken a sense of purpose that pushes us to live fully and authentically.

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## II. Deep Dive: Mortality and Fear

### 1. The Nature of Mortality

Many people live as if they were immortal, believing there will always be more time to change, love, or fulfill dreams. This illusion of invincibility often leads to procrastination and regret. When we finally realize that death is real and unavoidable, we begin to see how precious life truly is. Accepting mortality encourages us to live sincerely, forgive faster, and make each day meaningful.

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## 2. Analyzing the Fear of Death

Epicurus believed that death should not be feared because when we die, we no longer experience anything such as pain, suffering, or awareness. This thought brings comfort because it removes the idea of death as a source of horror. Personally, this view helps ease my fear. What worries me more is leaving my loved ones behind, not death itself. Epicurus' philosophy reminds me to focus on peace, kindness, and the quality of the life I live rather than fearing its end.

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## III. Day 1 Output & Reflection

The fear of death can both paralyze and inspire. For me, it helps me value life more deeply because it reminds me that everything has an end. Every laugh, conversation, and opportunity becomes meaningful when I remember that it might not happen again. Fear of death encourages me to appreciate the people I love and to make choices that matter. However, if this fear grows too strong, it can make life heavy and full of anxiety. The best way is to accept that death is part of life and to use it as motivation to live with love, pursue dreams, and be grateful for every moment I still have.

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## Day 2: Legacy, Remembrance, and Philosophical Perspectives

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### I. Review and Connection

The idea of the finite self shows that our existence is limited by time, while Epicurus teaches that fearing death is unnecessary. Together, they show that our knowledge of mortality pushes us to seek ways to be remembered. This desire to make a lasting difference gives meaning to our actions and transforms our fear of death into motivation for goodness and contribution.

### II. Deep Dive: Legacy and Meaning

#### 1. The Immortality Project

"What you leave behind is not what is engraved in stone monuments, but what is woven into the lives of others." –  
*Pericles*

This quote reflects the true meaning of legacy. It reminds us that our greatest achievements are not physical possessions or titles, but the positive influence we have on others. True immortality lies in kindness, inspiration, and the love we leave behind. Our legacy becomes a living memory carried by the people we have touched.

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## 2. Legacy vs. Fame

Fame and legacy are not the same. Fame often fades with time, built on popularity or temporary success, while legacy endures through the values and impact we leave behind. For instance, a famous celebrity might be remembered for trends, but a teacher, scientist, or ordinary person who changes lives creates something permanent. Legacy is not about being known by many; it is about being remembered by those who mattered.

**Personal Legacy Plan:**

- 1. I will share my knowledge and help others grow in their skills and confidence.
- 2.I will show kindness and empathy so that people remember me for my compassion.
- 3.I will live with integrity and hard work to inspire those who follow after me.

| View                              | Definition of the Human Person          | What Happens to Consciousness at Death                               |
|-----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Dualism<br>(Plato/Socrates)       | A human being is made of body and soul. | The soul separates from the body and continues to exist after death. |
| Materialism<br>(Atomists/Science) | A human being is entirely physical.     | Consciousness ends when the body dies.                               |

## 2. Camus and The Absurd

Camus described the “absurd” as the conflict between our desire for meaning and the universe’s silence. Despite this, he believed we should not give up. Instead, we must live passionately, rebel against despair, and find joy even in a meaningless world. Camus teaches that accepting life’s absurdity gives us freedom to create our own meaning and to live fully without expecting guarantees from the universe.

## IV. Final Synthesis and Assessment

### Final Philosophical Essay

Prompt: “The Ultimate Paradox: How the Certainty of Death Inspires the Meaning of Life.”

For me i dont really scared of death, even by now if its okay, i would take it. Human life is fragile and temporary. The awareness that our time on earth will eventually end shapes the way we live and the choices we make. The concept of the finite self reminds us that we exist within limits that every second passing is part of a countdown toward an unknown end. Knowing this, we begin to see time as something precious. Our goals, our relationships, and even our smallest acts gain meaning because they happen within a brief span. It is this limitation that teaches us to cherish each day, to forgive faster, and to love more sincerely.

Among the many philosophical responses to death, Albert Camus’s view of the Absurd deeply resonates with me. Camus believed that life is filled with a longing for meaning, yet the universe remains silent and indifferent. For him, death highlights this contradiction it ends everything before we can find absolute purpose. However, Camus does not suggest despair; instead, he invites us to rebel against the Absurd by living passionately and freely. In accepting that life is short and uncertain, we gain the courage to live fully without illusions.

The human desire for legacy and remembrance is another way we respond to mortality. Knowing that we will die pushes us to leave traces of ourselves behind whether through kindness, knowledge, or positive impact. Legacy does not always mean fame or monuments; it can simply be the love and lessons we leave to our families, the compassion we show to others, or the inspiration we spark in our communities. Through these acts, our influence continues even after our physical life ends, making our existence meaningful.

Personally, I believe that facing death should not fill us with fear, but with appreciation. Death gives life its shape, like a frame that defines a painting. It reminds us to live intentionally to pursue what matters, to connect deeply, and to create rather than waste time. Accepting mortality allows us to experience life not as something endless, but as something worth living for. In the certainty of death, I find the reason to live more honestly, gratefully, and purposefully every single day.